Make a start menu

Digital Technologies · School computers

You will

- make a menu with your game's name and a Play button
- make the Play button open your game
- make your game start at the menu

You need

- your Godot project open, with a main scene (see the guide Make a Godot project)

Before you start

- A menu is a scene of its own. Its button sends a signal when clicked, and a line of code changes to your game's scene.
- Name scenes in lowercase, like `start_menu.tscn`.

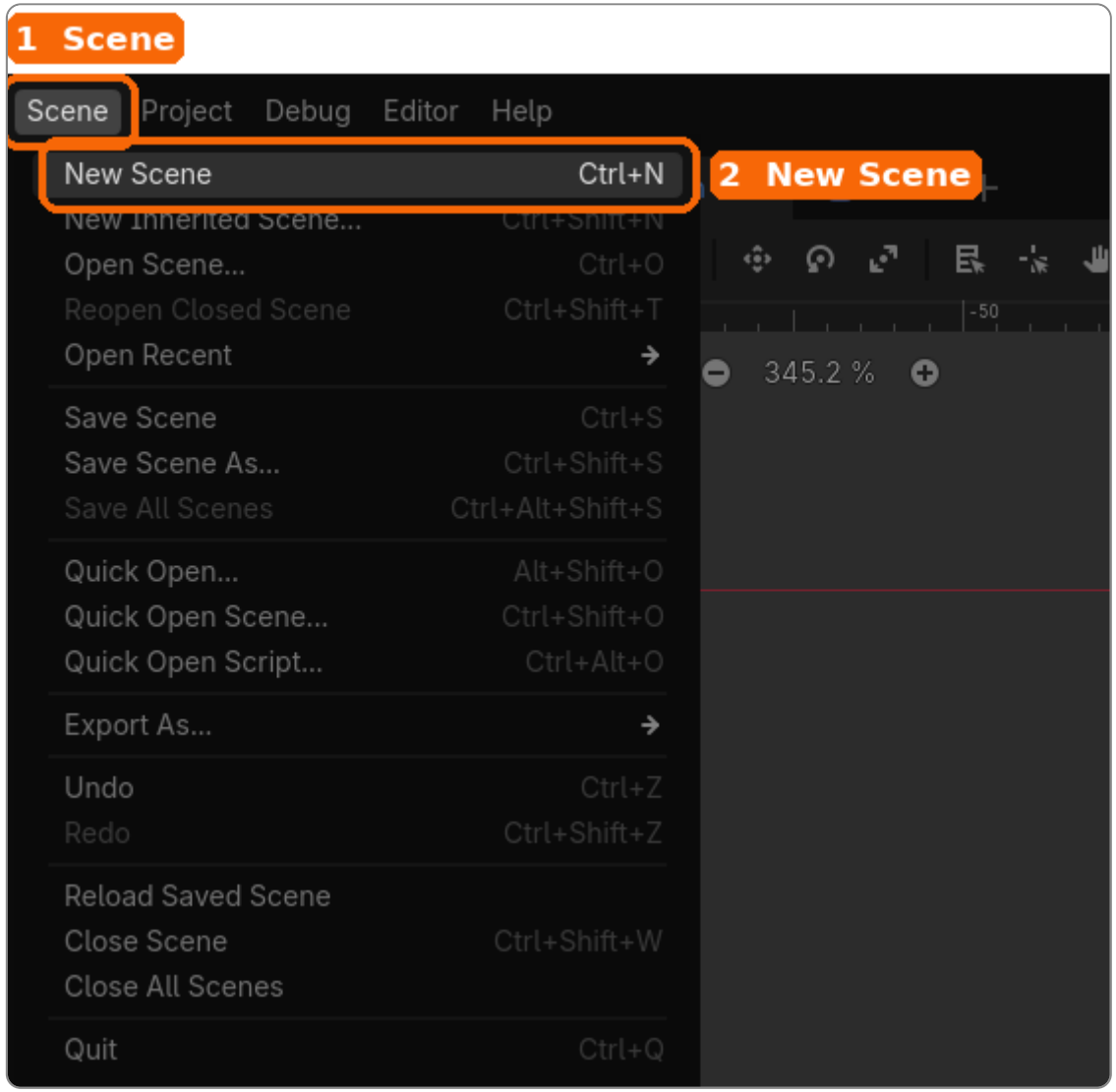
 Click here  Look here

1

Godot › Scene menu

Click **Scene** › **New Scene**.

Or press Ctrl + N. A new, empty tab opens.

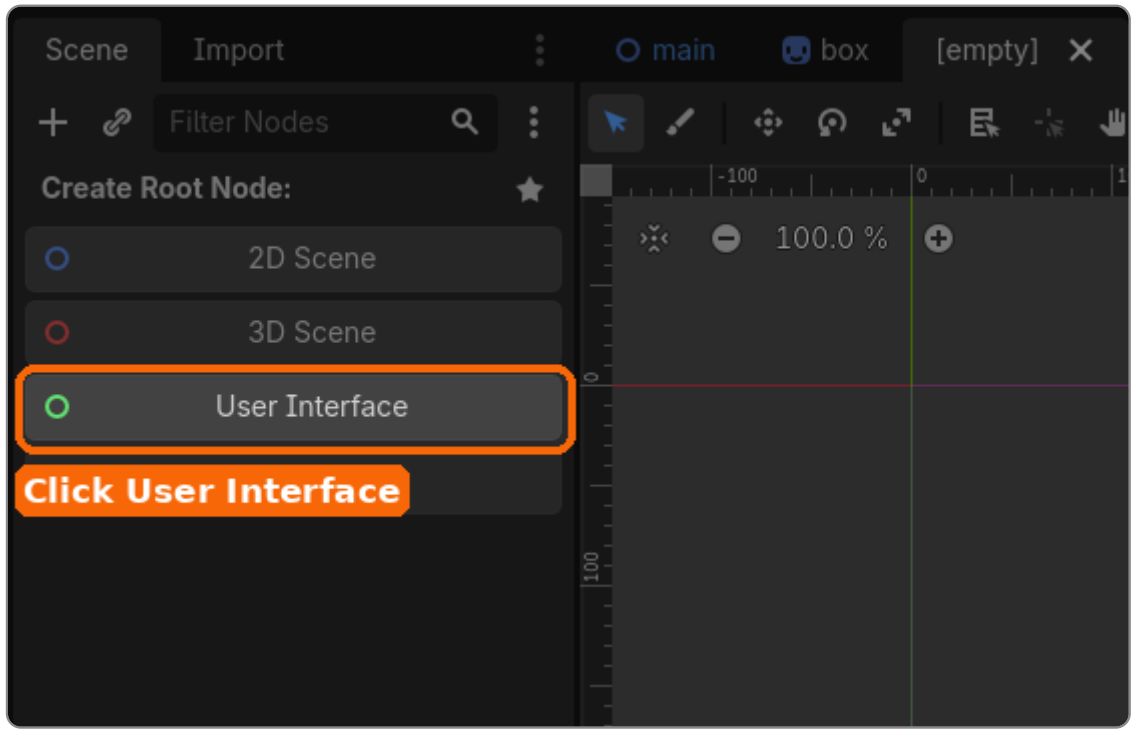


2

Godot › Scene dock › new scene

Under **Create Root Node**, click **User Interface**.

This makes a **Control** node, the root for menus, buttons and text.



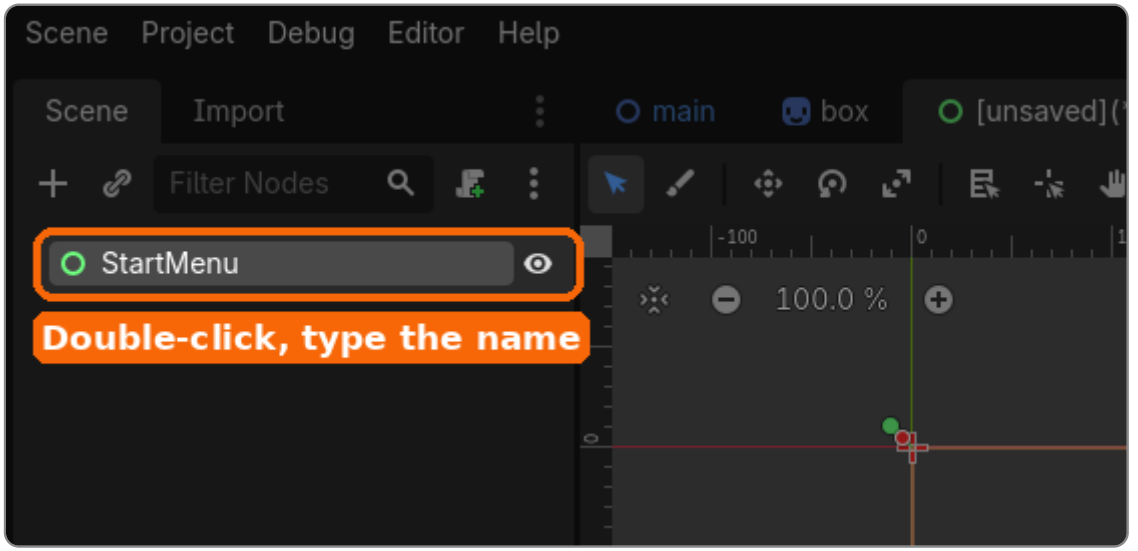
3

Godot › Scene dock

Double-click **Control**.

Type a name that starts with a capital (like `StartMenu`), and press `Enter`.

Or click it and press `F2`.



4

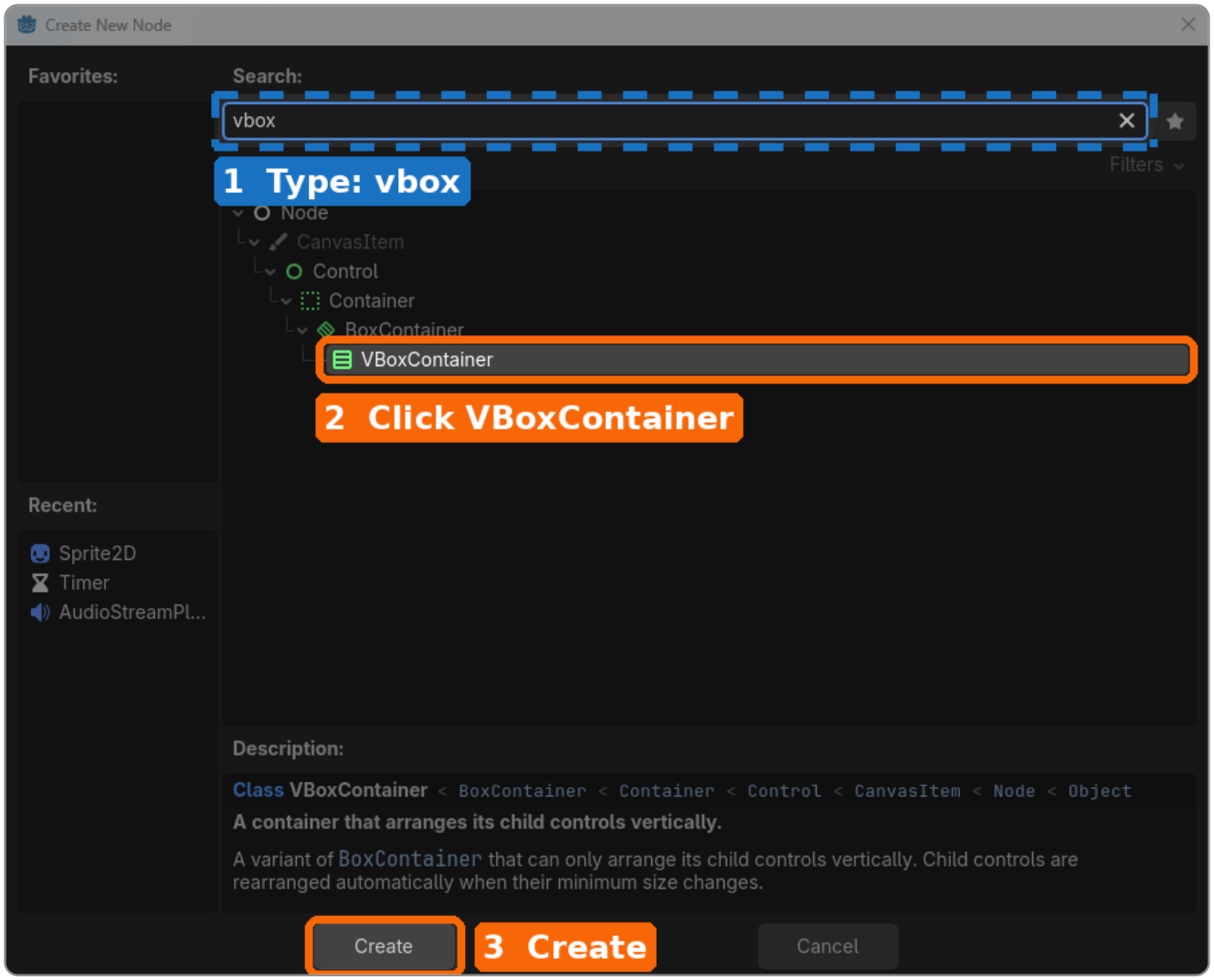
Godot › Create New Node

With your top node selected, click **+** (or press `Ctrl` + `A`).

Type `vbox`.

Click **VBoxContainer**, then **Create**.

A VBoxContainer stacks everything inside it in a neat column.



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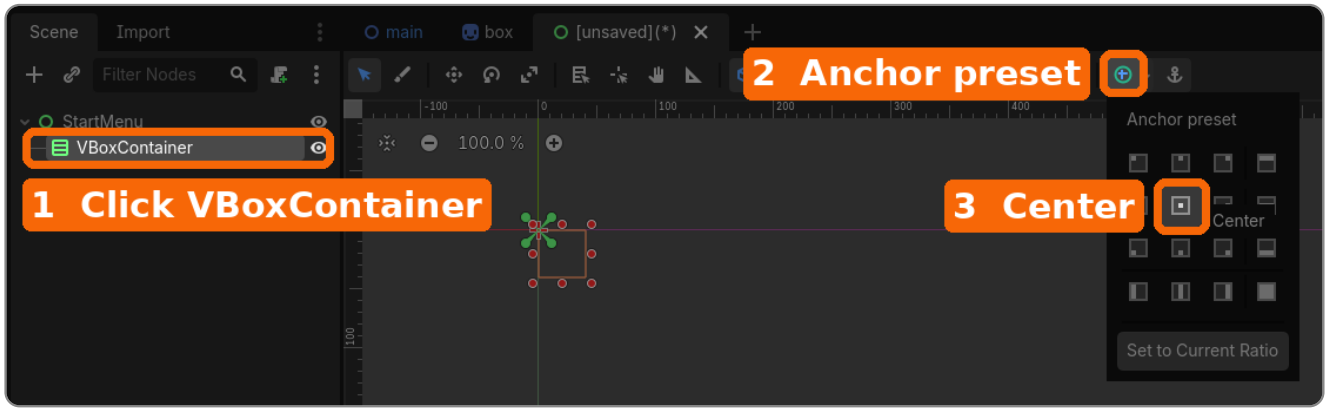
Godot › 2D view toolbar

Click **VBoxContainer** in the Scene dock.

Click the green anchor button above the 2D view.

Click the middle square, **Center**.

This keeps your menu in the middle of the game window.



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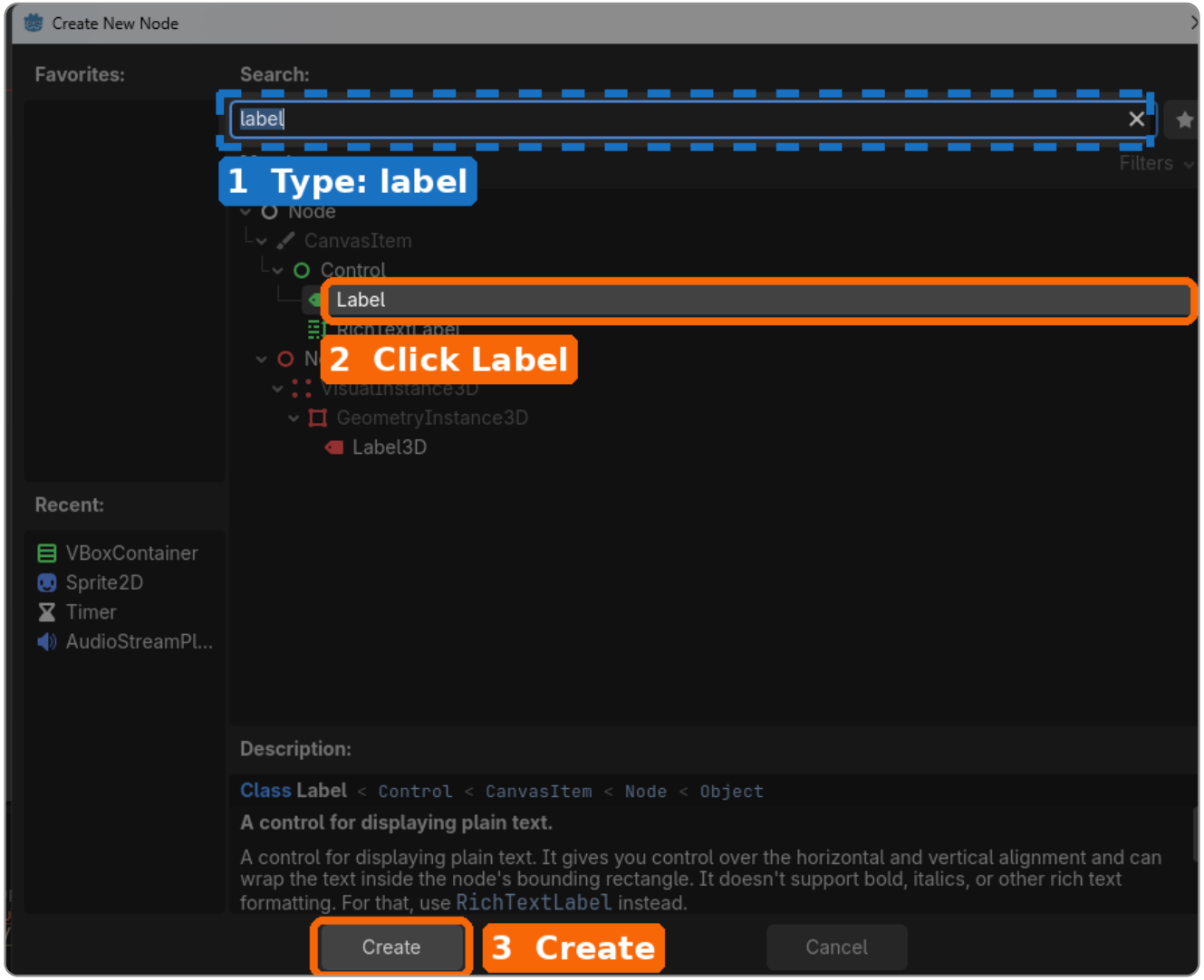
Godot › Create New Node

Click **VBoxContainer**, then **+**.

Type `label`.

Click **Label**, then **Create**.

A Label shows text, like your game's name.



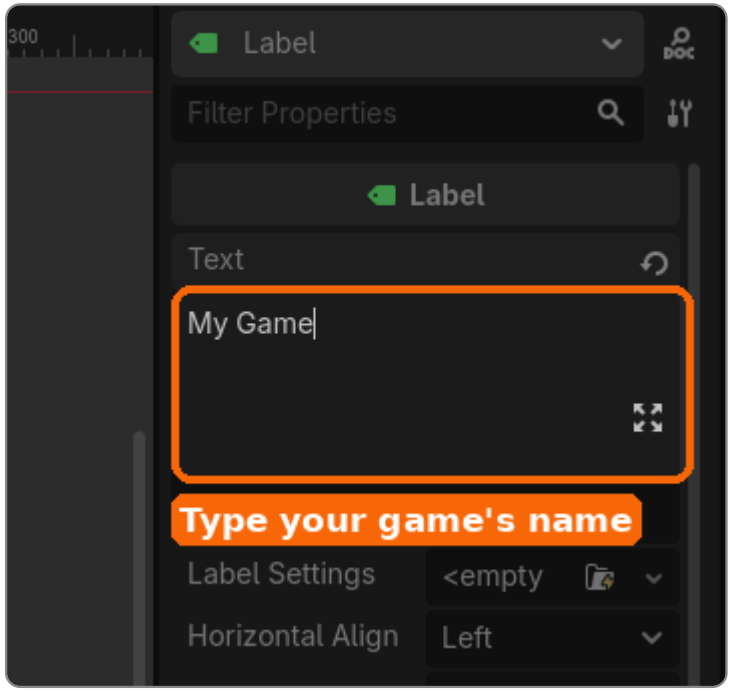
7

Godot › Inspector › Label

With **Label** selected, click in the **Text** box.

Type your game's name.

> **Check:** your game's name shows in the 2D view.



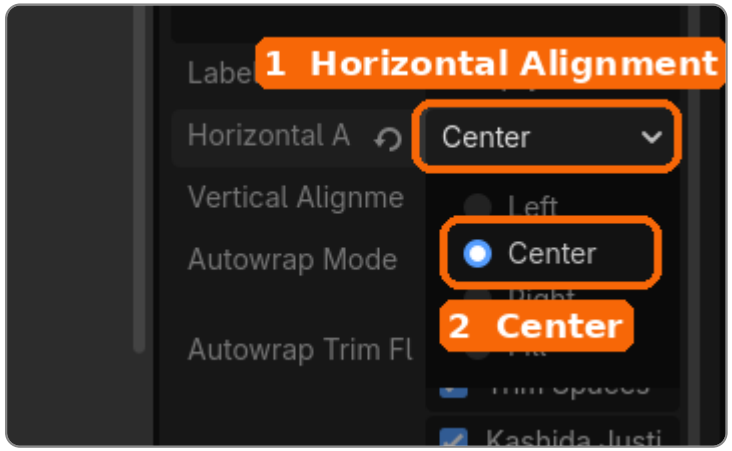
8

Godot › Inspector › Label

Click the box next to **Horizontal Alignment**.

Click **Center**.

This centres the name above the button.



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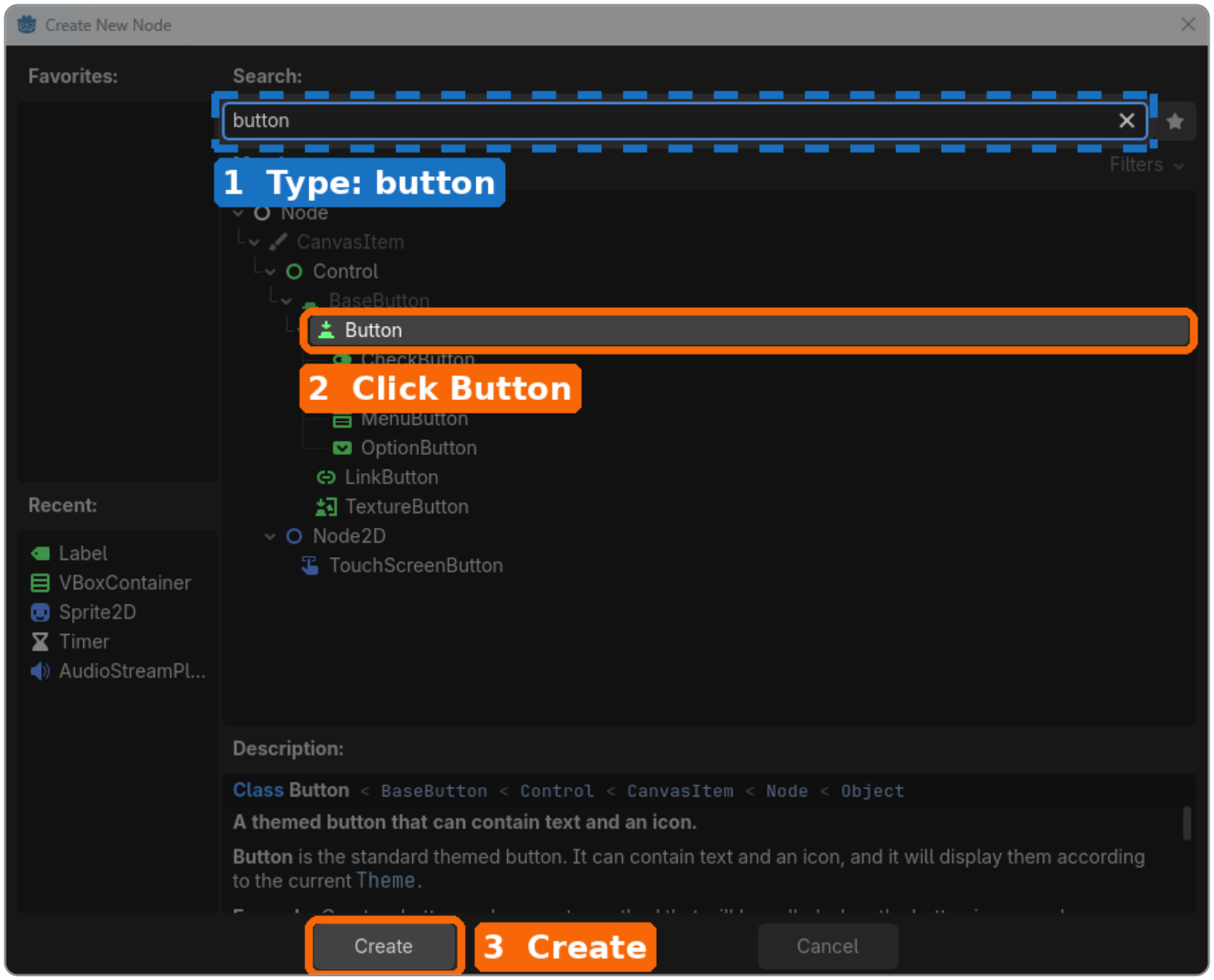
Godot › Create New Node

Click **VBoxContainer**, then **+**.

Type `button`.

Click **Button**, then **Create**.

The Button goes under the Label in the Scene dock, so it shows below it.



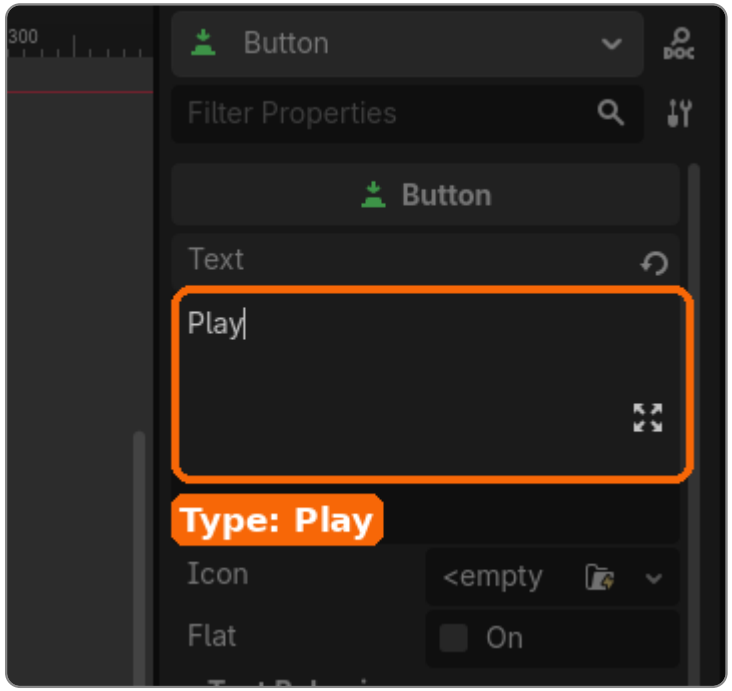
10

Godot › Inspector › Button

With **Button** selected, click in the **Text** box.

Type `Play`.

> **Check:** a Play button under your game's name.



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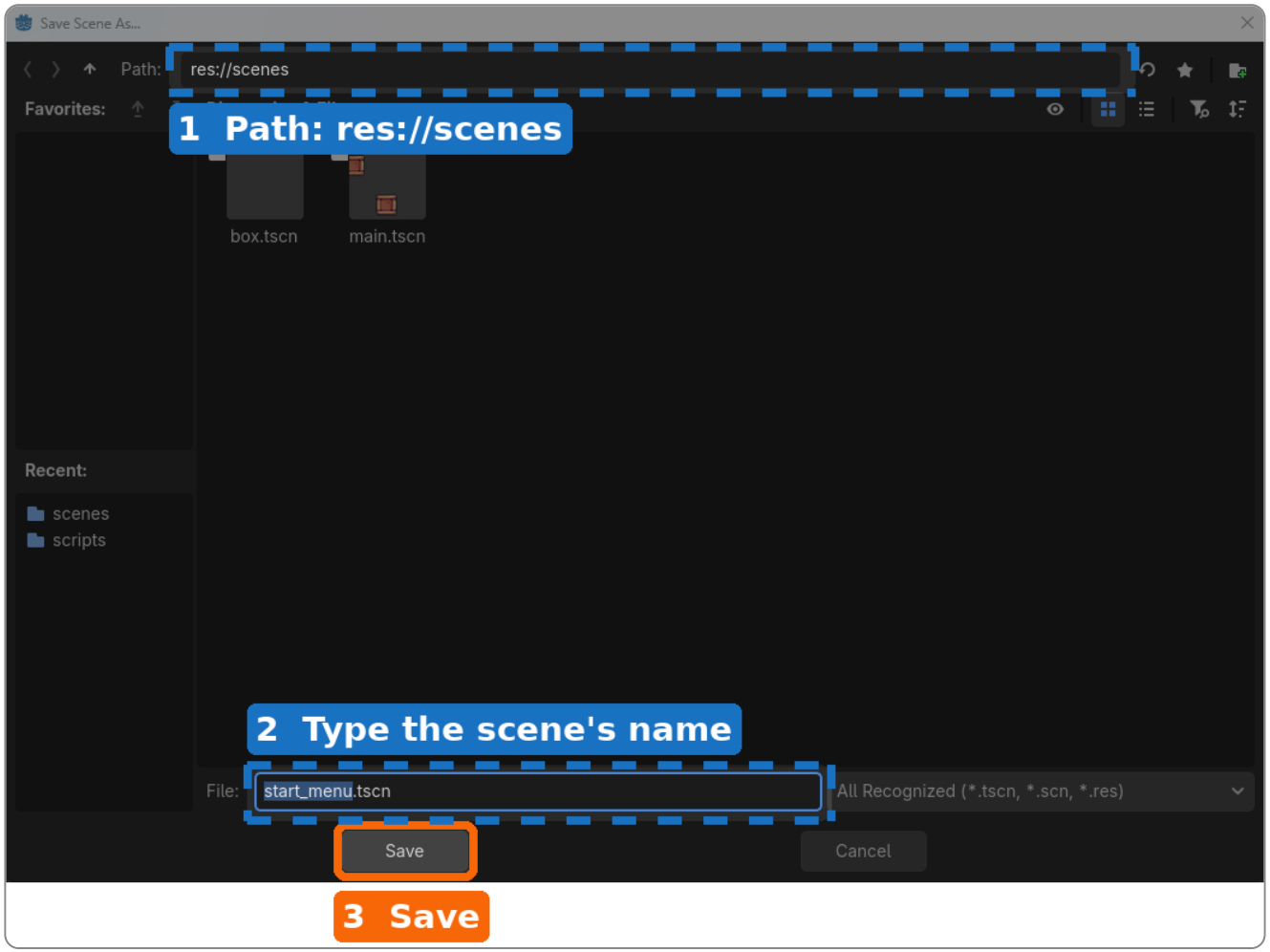
Godot › Save Scene As

Press `Ctrl` + `S` (or **Scene** › **Save Scene**).

Check **Path** says `res://scenes`. Double-click the `scenes` folder if it doesn't.

Check the name, like `start_menu.tscn`, then click **Save**.

> **Check:** your menu scene in the `scenes` folder in FileSystem.



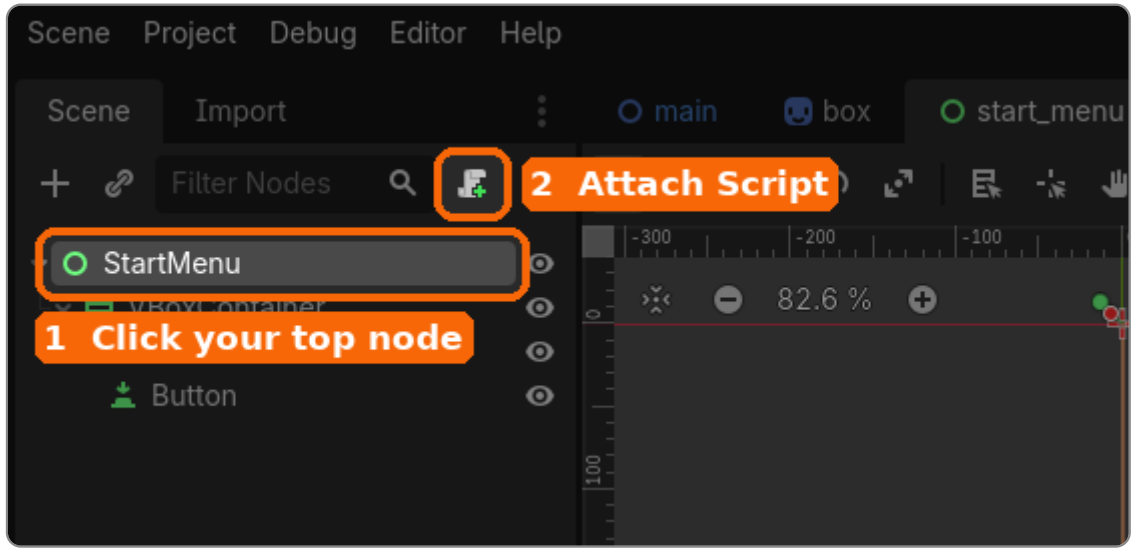
12

Godot › Scene dock

Click your top node (here, StartMenu).

Click **Attach Script**, the scroll with a green **+**.

The script goes on the top node, so it can look after the whole menu.



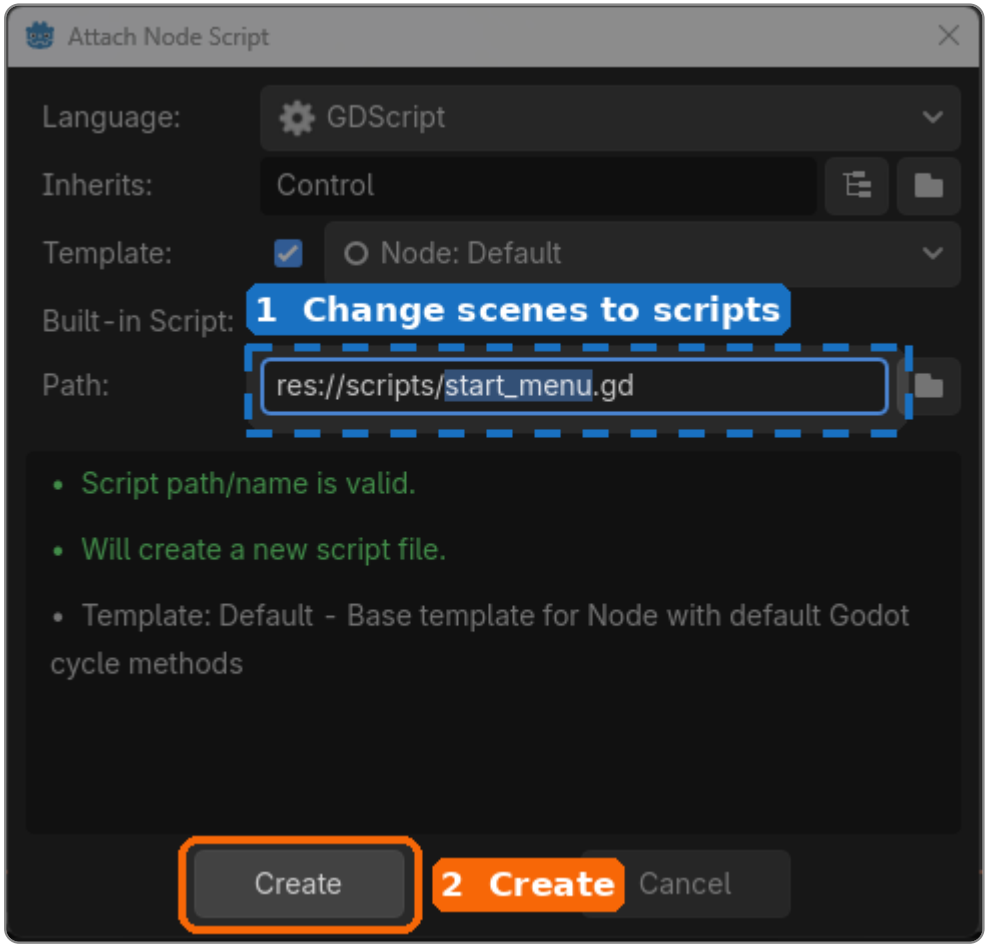
13

Godot › Attach Node Script

In **Path**, change `scenes` to `scripts`.

Click **Create**.

No `scripts` folder yet? Leave the path as it is.



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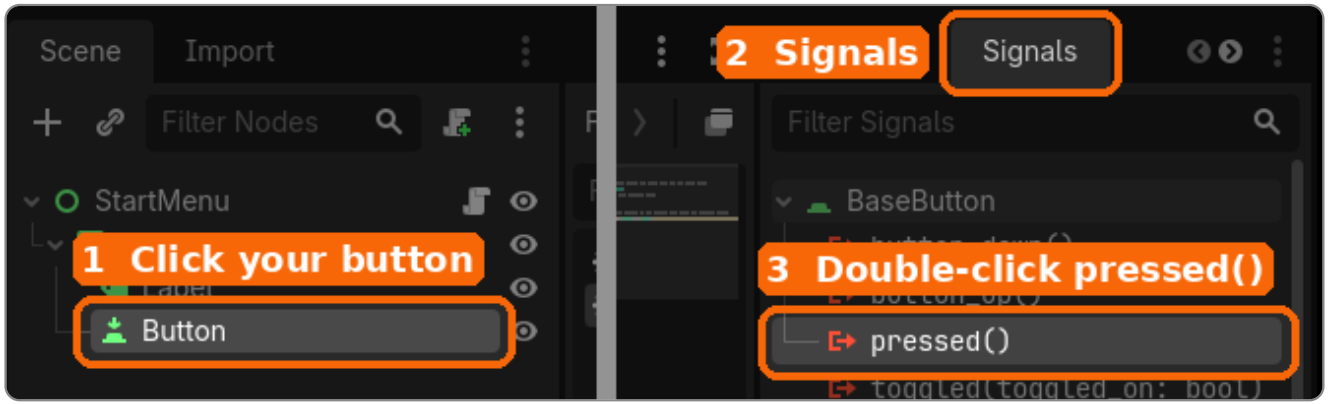
Godot › Signals

Click your button in the Scene dock.

Click the **Signals** tab, next to **Inspector**.

Double-click `pressed()`.

A Button sends pressed() each time it's clicked.



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Godot › Connect a Signal to a Method

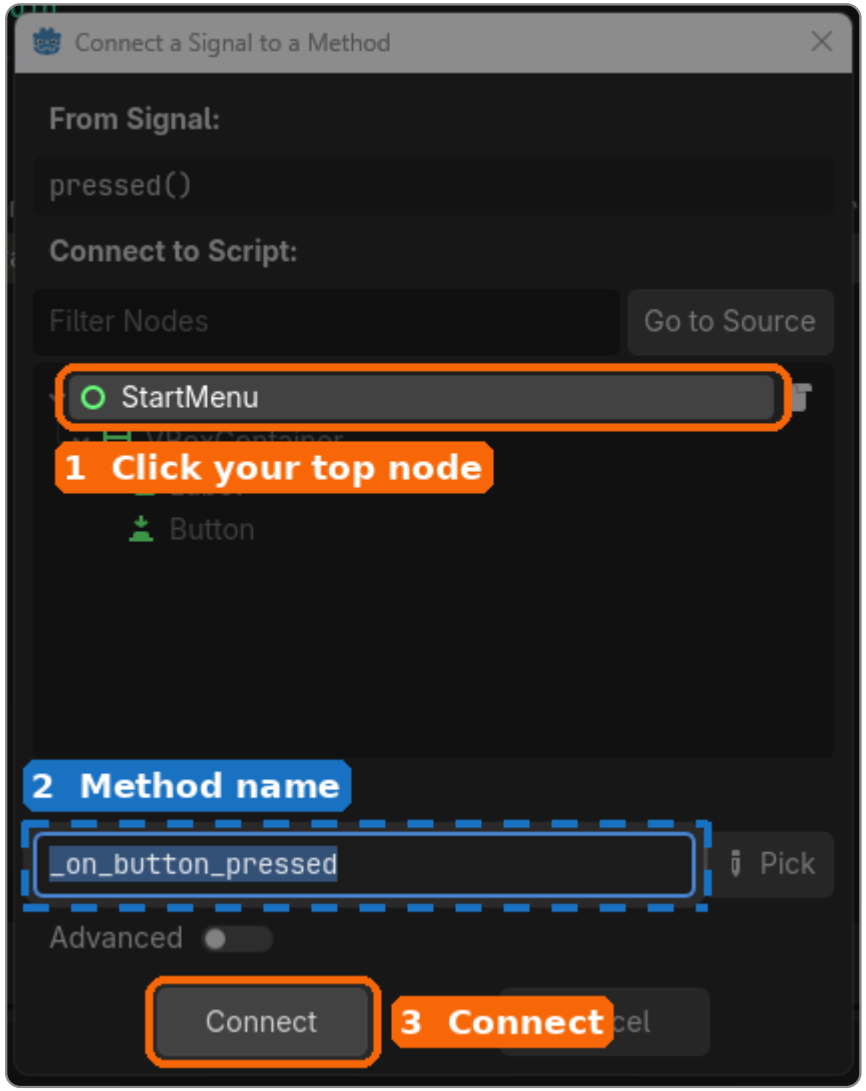
Click your top node (here, StartMenu).

Leave the **Receiver Method** name as it is.

Click **Connect**.

Godot opens your script with a new function at the end.

If something goes wrong
Your top node is grey: it has no script yet. Close this window and attach one first.



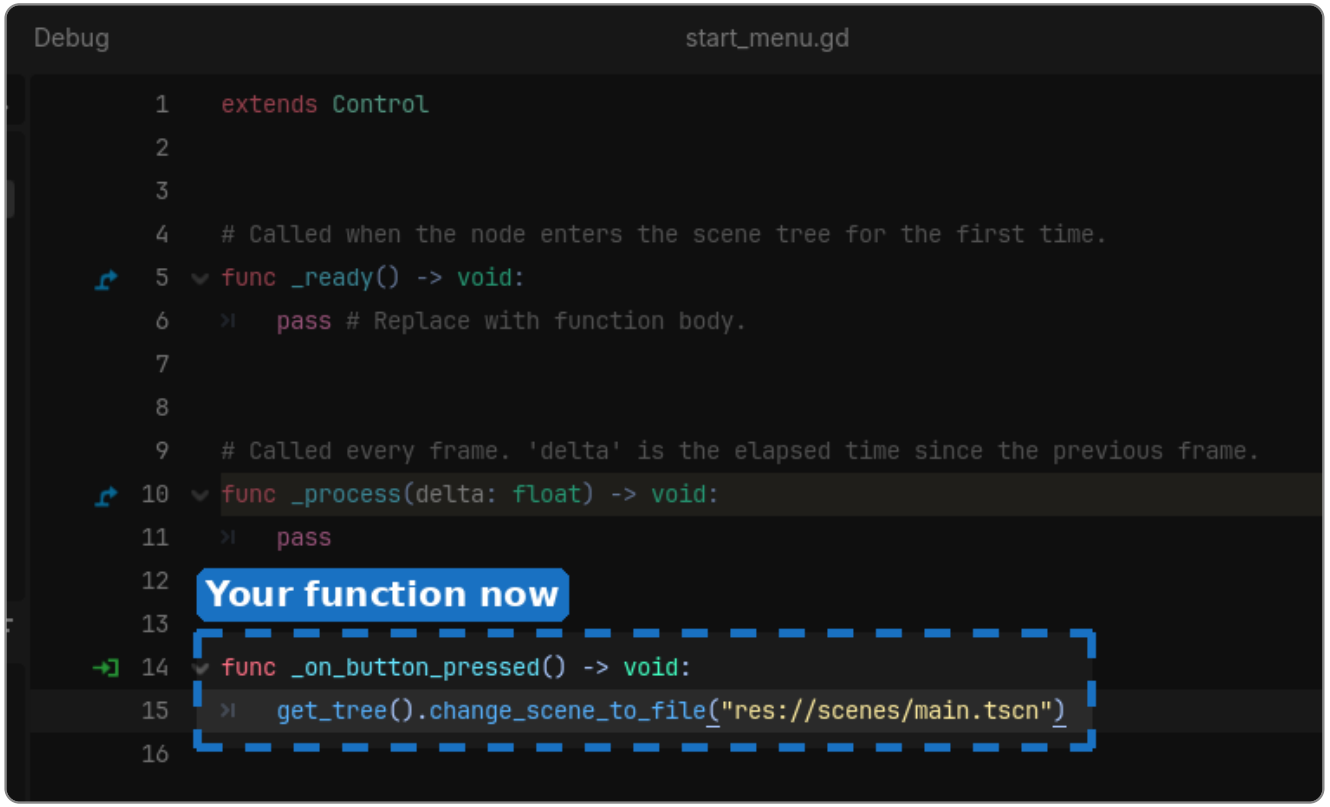
In the new function, replace `pass` so it looks like this:

```
func _on_button_pressed() -> void:
→   get_tree().change_scene_to_file("res://scenes/main.tscn")
```

Press `Ctrl` + `S`.

Each arrow is one `Tab`. Use your own main scene's path: right-click it in FileSystem, click **Copy Path**, then paste it between the quotes.

If something goes wrong
Two func lines: replace only `pass`. Keep the func line Godot made.



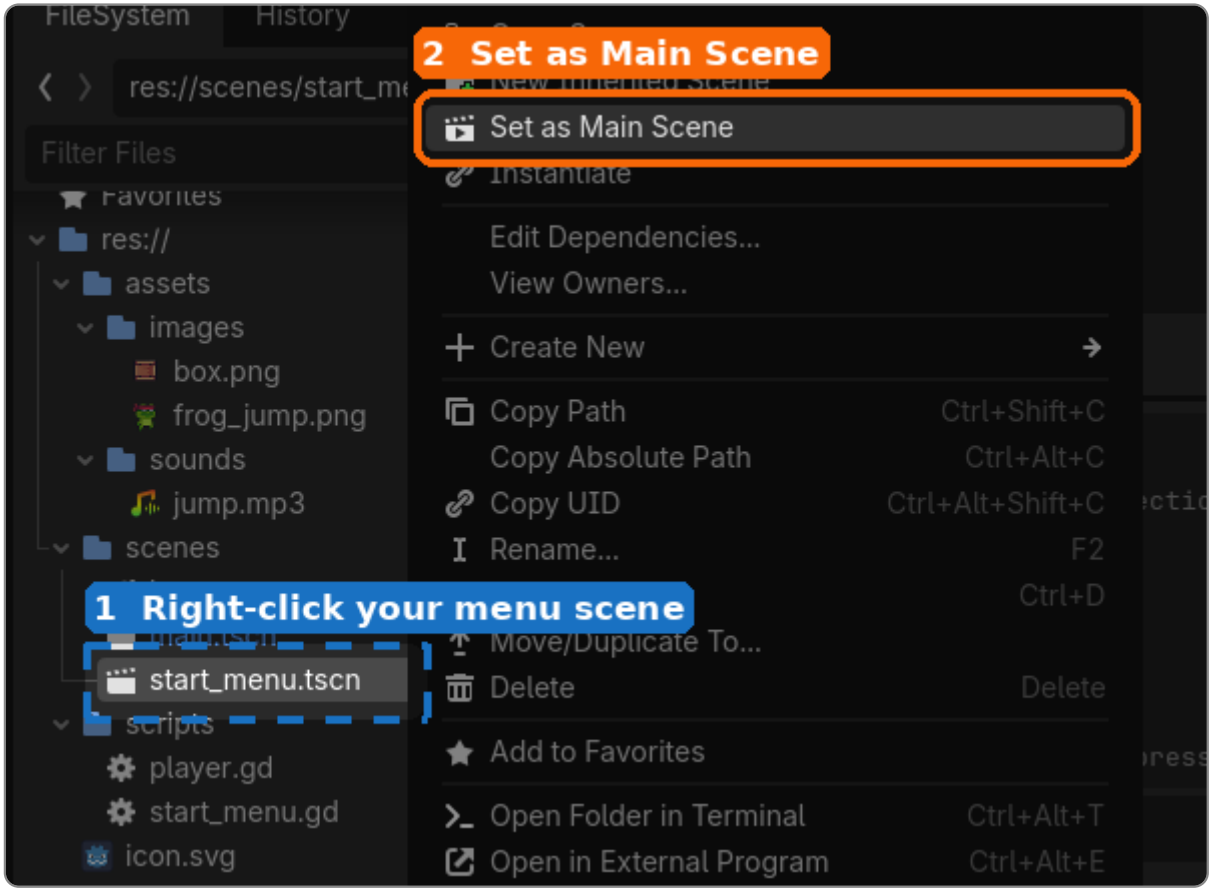
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Godot › FileSystem

Right-click your menu scene.

Click **Set as Main Scene**.

Your game now starts at the menu.



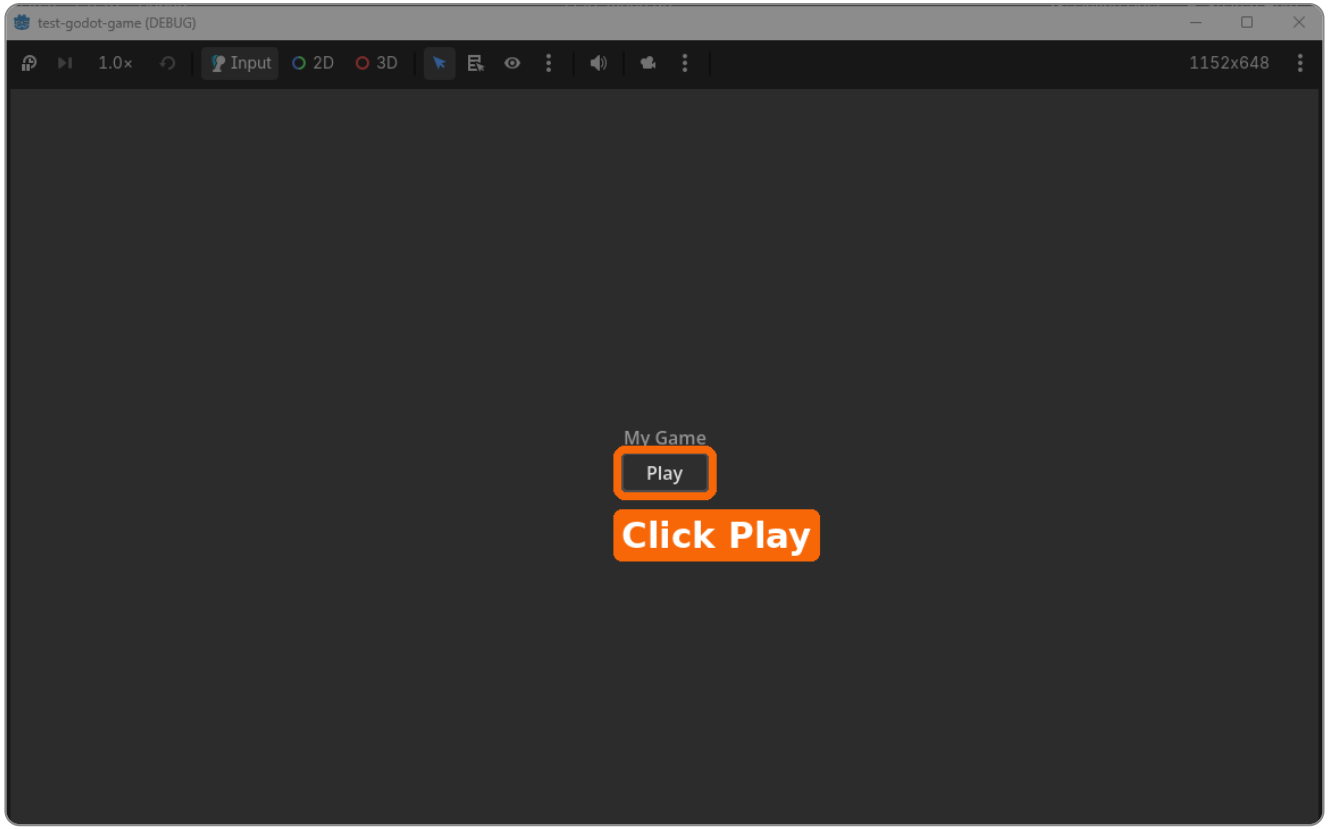
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Godot › Your game window

Press F5.

Click **Play**.

> **Check:** your menu shows when the game starts.



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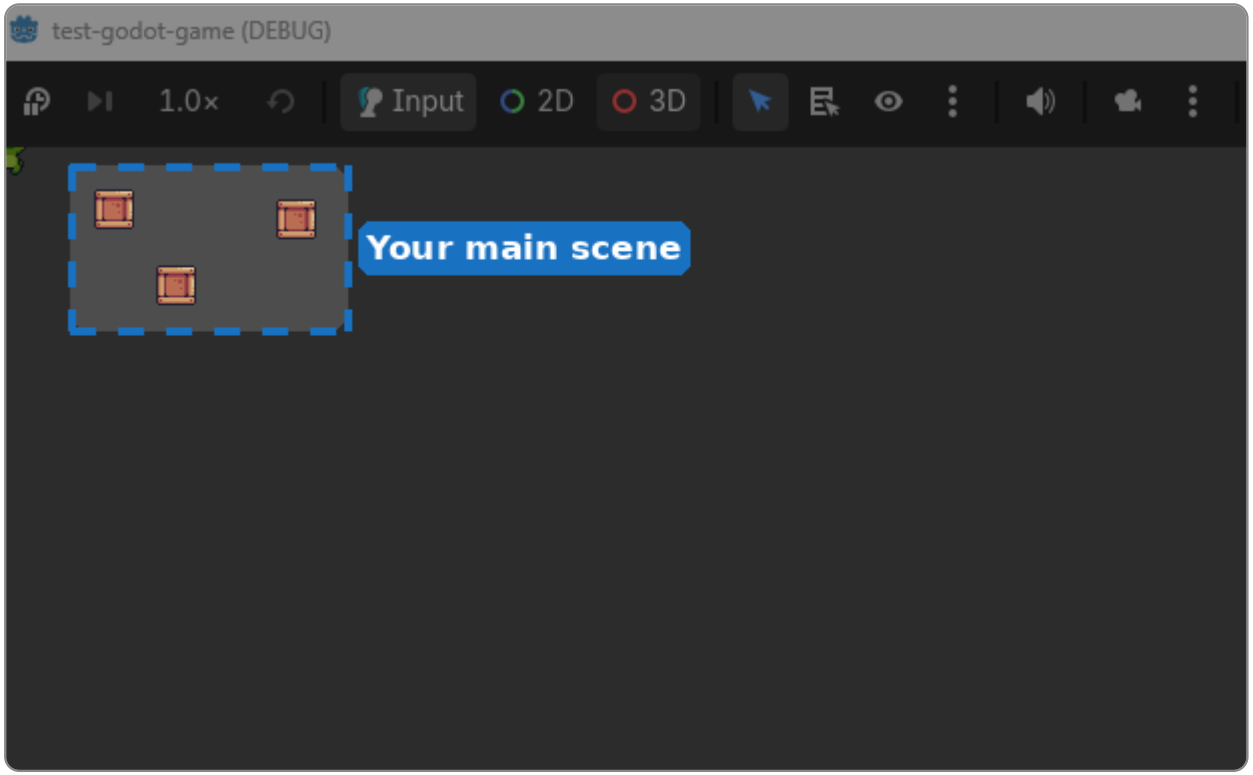
Godot › Your game window

Check your main scene opens.

Press F8 to stop.

Check: your main scene appears after you click Play.

If something goes wrong
Nothing happens, or an error appears: check the path in your code matches your main scene's name in FileSystem, letter for letter.



More buttons

Add another Button under VBoxContainer, connect its pressed() signal to your top node, and write what it does in the new function.

If your project is on GitHub

Commit and push with GitHub Desktop, as usual, with every file ticked: the new scene, the new script and `project.godot`, which remembers the main scene.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can make a menu with a title and a button.
- [ ] My Play button opens my game.
- [ ] My game starts at the menu.